

Unearthing Joy

Unearthing Joy. A Guide to Culturally and Historically Responsive Teaching and Learning. *Muhammad, G. (2023).*

Scholastic

Read the following:

- Introduction. Watering the earth with educational excellence.
 - Culturally and Historically Responsive Education (CHRE) is grounded in and responsive to the histories, identities, literacies and liberation (HILL) of children and the social world
 - Genius is knowing who we are and whose we are. Knowing social-emotional intelligence and knowing how to make ourselves smile.
 - Children have been identified for what they can't do instead of for who they truly are and they are truly capable of. Children may internalize the negativity and see themselves in deficit ways.
 - Proficiency in reading and math is not targeted to real world problems or contexts.
 - The pursuit of joy is helping students to uplift beauty, aesthetics, truth, ease, wonder, wellness, solutions to the problems of the world, and personal fulfillment. Joy is the ultimate goal of teaching and learning.
 - We must draw forth pedagogies of equity and excellence, moving students and educators to genius and joy.
 - Children are like flowers. They are geniuses by nature. When flowers don't grow, we nourish them, we change the environmental factors. We should do the same with our students.
- Chapter 1. Unearthing the need for genius and joy.
 - Equity is teaching and learning that is centered on justice, liberation, truth, and freedom and is free of bias and favoritism.
 - Equity without addressing structural oppression/racism is not true equity.
 - Textbooks that followed A Measuring Rod taught false and distorted depictions of American and Black history.
 - The New England Primer established the following problems
 - Centered on whiteness and white representation with no diversity
 - Was apolitical and lacked criticality and social justice
 - No opportunities for all children to see themselves or make sense of multiple identities
 - Privileged the English language
 - Promoted skills and did not explicitly offer opportunities for cultivating pursuits of identity, intellectualism, criticality and joy
 - Implications on Education Today

- Teaching and Learning Standards and Policies
 - State standards are written to address only skills but do not consider identity, intellect, criticality, and joy.
 - By reframing standards according to the five pursuits above, we contextualize skills and give students ways to connect them to the real world and their lives.
- Curriculum and Instruction
 - Mostly skills-driven, absent of cultural and historical responsiveness.
 - Create a rubric for curriculum writers to follow.
- Assessments and State Tests
 - We must show that we value more than skills.
 - Provide tests in multiple languages
- Teacher and Leader Evaluations
- Teacher Education Programs

Guiding prompts for this reading:

1. Explain why joy is an important component for teaching and learning
2. Identify the representations/metaphors related to the role of educators/education
3. Describe the implications of past decisions (e.g., The New England Primer) about curriculum in today's schools

Learning Theories

Learning Theories

Explore a few (between 3 - 5) of the learning theories listed in the following two links.

[Theories of learning 1](#)

1. Cognitive Load Theory: Teachers need to take into account the mind's cognitive architecture when teaching i.e., working memory can only hold a certain amount of information at once. Too much information leads to cognitive overload and learning will stop.
2. Play-Based Learning Theory: Play is an effective mechanism for supporting learning and early childhood development. These benefits could also be gained through playing on digital devices.
3. Psychosocial Theory: Built on Freud's psychoanalytic approach that states that child development is driven by psychological and sexual desires. It has largely been dismissed by educational theorists. The Psychosocial theory places far less emphasis on sexuality and focuses on social relationships. Helps teachers know what key challenges to focus on at each age level.

[Theories of learning 2](#)

1. Andragogy: A theory for adult learning specifically. Adults are self-directed and expect to take responsibility for decisions. More focus on process and less on the content.
2. Dual Coding Theory: Equal weight to verbal and non-verbal processing. The theory assumes there are 2 cognitive subsystems, one for representation and processing of nonverbal objects and the other for dealing with language. These can be represented as imagens for mental images (organized as part-whole relationships) and logogens for verbal entities (organized in terms of associations and hierarchies). The theory identifies 3 types of processing - Representational (direct activation of either representation), Referential (activation of one representation by the other), and Associative (activation of representations within the same system)
3. Multiple Intelligences - An individual possesses distinct forms of intelligence in varying degrees. 7 forms include Linguistic, Musical, Logical-Mathematical, Spatial, Body-Kinesthetic, Intrapersonal (Insight, Metacognition) and Interpersonal (Social skills). Learning or teaching should focus on the particular intelligences of each person. Assessment of abilities should measure all forms of intelligence. Different cultures emphasize different intelligences.

Think about:

1. What learning theories do you know?
I had previously read about Multiple Intelligences. I did vaguely know of the theories behind Cognitive Load, Play-Based Learning, Andragogy, Dual Coding and Multiple Intelligences
2. Which ones resonate with you OR connect with the experiences you have?
TEED-5110 used Andragogy a lot! I also resonate with Multiple Intelligences, Play-Based Learning and Cognitive Load
3. Which ones do you find surprising?
4. Which ones do you disagree with?

I strongly disagree with Freud's psychoanalytic approach.

Mind Maps Video

Mind Maps Video

1. Why are mind maps important?

Thinking techniques, one of the ways we think most effectively
Boost productivity, creativity, memory and comprehension

2. What are the main elements you should use when building a mind map?

Eye catching central image, curved branches reflecting ideas
Mind maps are infinite
One keyword per branch
Colors and images

3. How could you use mind maps in your future classroom?

Could be used to plan out a curriculum

For your mind map, you can use an electronic tool (e.g., Coggle or Lucidchat)